. Ghazi Khan Tannuri was the second prisoner (along with Abul Ma'ali) that Bairam Khan released before his angry bid for Punjab. Years after the canny regent's defeat and death, his plans were still playing out.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.
.Ibid.
. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 4, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. The conquering king as lord, master, and husband of the conquered land was a common metaphor of the times. Norman P. Ziegler notes how, in Rajput texts, 'The kingdom itself was conceived of as the product of marriage between a ruler, who was both God and master (*thakur*) and husband (*dhani*), and the land (*dharti* – from Sanskrit *dharitri* – "a female bearer"), which was his wife.' The metaphor is complicated, naturally, if the ruler is a queen. See Norman P. Ziegler, 'Some Notes on Rajput Loyalties during the Mughal Period', in *The Mughal State: 1526–1750*, eds Muzaffar Alam and Sanjay Subrahmanyam (Oxford University Press, 1998).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2. The account of the battle that follows is Abul Fazl's, unless I have indicated otherwise.
. Shaikh Illahdad Faizi Sirhindi, 'Akbarnama', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 6 (Trübner and Co., 1875).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.
. The pots were filled with gold coins, possibly from the time Alauddin Khilji. See *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2, and Mahomed Kasim Ferishta, *History of the Rise of the Mahomedan Power in India till the Year A.D. 1612*, vol. 2, trans. John Briggs (R. Cambray & Co., 1909).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2. The following descriptions of Akbar's time in the forest and his hunt for Abdullah the Uzbek are based on Abul Fazl's account.
. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 4, trans. W.M. Thackston.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe. Badauni also notes that, by the time of his writing some three decades later, 'of that city and edifice not a trace now is left'.
. Rohtas, less than 300 kilometres south-east of Jaunpur, in Bihar, is among the many impregnable fortresses that fill the Indian landscape, towering tributes to the power and wealth once guarded by their thick walls and jutting turrets. Rohtas had the advantage, too, of encompassing fertile land and plenty of water – 'such an abundance', Badauni wrote, that 'if one drives a nail into the ground . . . water comes up'. Naturally, Akbar would have been happy to have it for his own.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.
. Husain, *The Nobility under Akbar and Jahangir*.
. Khan, *The Political Biography of a Mughal Noble*.
. According to Abul Fazl, Akbar preferred to offer the job to Ali Quli's brother, Bahadur, who was, in fact, appointed vakil for a brief and unspecified time.
. To this end, having chased Abdullah the Uzbek out of Malwa, Akbar did not merely appoint a new governor to the region but also left behind a group of imperial overseers to watch over him. As Nizamuddin writes, 'an order was made directing a party of the Imperial followers who remained behind in Mandu to stay in that province along with Karra Bahadur [the new governor], and zealously serve His Majesty'.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.
. Worse, Abul Fazl writes that when Kamran was eventually exiled, he spoke to Humayun about his children, and that Humayun 'gladly promised to care for them'. Little did Kamran realize that it was his nephew who would decide his cousins' fate.
. Ferishta, for example, writes that '[Kamran] left three daughters and one son, Abool Kasim Mirza, who, some time after his father's decease, was put to death by order of Akbur, in the fort of